Rafael Jr. R. Canalda

Aspiring Penetration Tester and Cybersecurity Engineer

Taguig City, Philippines rafael.canaldajr@gmail.com linkedin.com/in/rafaelcanalda github.com/raflearns

Summary

Information Technology student majoring in Information Network Security, building toward a career in penetration testing. 1st runner-up in the INFOTECH '26 cybersecurity competition and holder of four Cisco Networking Academy credentials covering networking and network defense. Brings a hands-on troubleshooting background from hardware repair and a data analytics foundation. Looking for a cybersecurity or IT internship where I can contribute to security assessments while continuing to grow.

Competitions

1st Runner-up, INFOTECH '26 Cybersecurity Competition 2026
College of Computing and Information Sciences, University of Makati. Team Sudo RFAM.

Rank 16, Packet Capture: Beneath the Network CTF Oct 2026
Packet Capture × CyberPH, online. Scored 2,229 points and captured 24 flags with a five-person team.

Certifications, Cisco Networking Academy

Network Defense	Sep 2026	**Networking Basics**	Sep 2026
Introduction to Cybersecurity	Aug 2026	**Introduction to Packet Tracer**	Aug 2026

Training: CyberConvergence 2026 Cyber Defenders Summit, UMak CCIS and PICSPro (Oct 2026).

Technical skills

Security: threat and vulnerability fundamentals, firewall configuration, endpoint hardening (Linux, Windows), PKI and data protection, identity lifecycle management

Networking: IPv4/IPv6 addressing, routing and Ethernet fundamentals, connectivity troubleshooting, wireless security, Cisco Packet Tracer

Programming: Java (OOP), Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, MySQL

Other: PC and electronics hardware diagnostics, data analysis, Microsoft Excel

Projects

Laundrify POS Java, MySQL
Standalone point-of-sale system for laundry shops with cashier logins, a queue manager and cash or QR payments, built around reliable local transaction records.

Predictive Modeling Python, Excel, MySQL
Statistical models forecasting trends from discrete data sets, using rule-based logic instead of interpolation for more accurate results.

Education

BS Information Technology, major in Information Network Security 2025 – Present
University of Makati. Coursework: Network Security, Database Management, Object-Oriented Programming.

Senior High School, STEM – Data Analytics 2023 – 2025
University of Makati. Coursework: Data Analysis, Probability and Statistics, Programming.

Experience

Independent Electronics Technician 2023 – Present
Diagnose and repair mobile devices, audio equipment and peripherals, tracing faults component by component.

Also: crew member, McDonald's (2023 – 2025); freelance graphic designer (2024 – 2025).

Languages

English, Filipino